Pack the Right Sack

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 12

At Fern Lodge, Nib wrapped the final invitation in spare cloth. Then he added another piece, and another, until the destination mark vanished. The caretaker's receiving instructions were fixed beside a folded sack. Lark looked from the neat instruction to the enormous anonymous bundle.

“Packed beyond all recognition,” Nib reported proudly. “Recognition is part of the job,” Lark reminded him kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

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“Here c and k work together for one /k/ sound,” Lark explained clearly. “Read pack, then sack. Don't sound the pair twice. Capital P has the same beginning sound as little p. In Pack it, two words give us one useful instruction.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try pack, sack, back, sock. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read Pack it,” Lark invited warmly. “Which protection keeps the envelope safe while leaving its destination visible?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can pack. Pat can pack.**

“Can both friends pack?” Lark asked gently. “Check that each sentence tells us so.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib removed the extra wrapping. The protective folio fitted into the intended sack without hiding the destination. Lark posted the Fern Lodge invitation through the receiving flap. The caretaker's note promised a reply at the same sack hook. All three outward invitations had reached their destinations; the return circuit could begin.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write pack beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the sack hook as your third reply-collection place. Nib's three delivery pockets were empty for a good reason. A small signal bell beside the porch made only a muffled hiss when its cord moved.